

Miami Knows Beauty

Customer Payment Journey Walkthrough — Owner Upgrade Flow

June 13, 2026 · Prepared by Posey, Product Manager

This document walks through the end-to-end experience a Miami salon owner has when they discover Miami Knows Beauty, find their existing listing, sign in, and upgrade to a paid Featured plan via Stripe.

Screenshots were captured on June 12, 2026 against the live production site at **miami.knowsbeauty.com** (preview mode, Stripe live environment). Each step includes commentary on what is working well and any gaps that need attention before we can confidently go live.

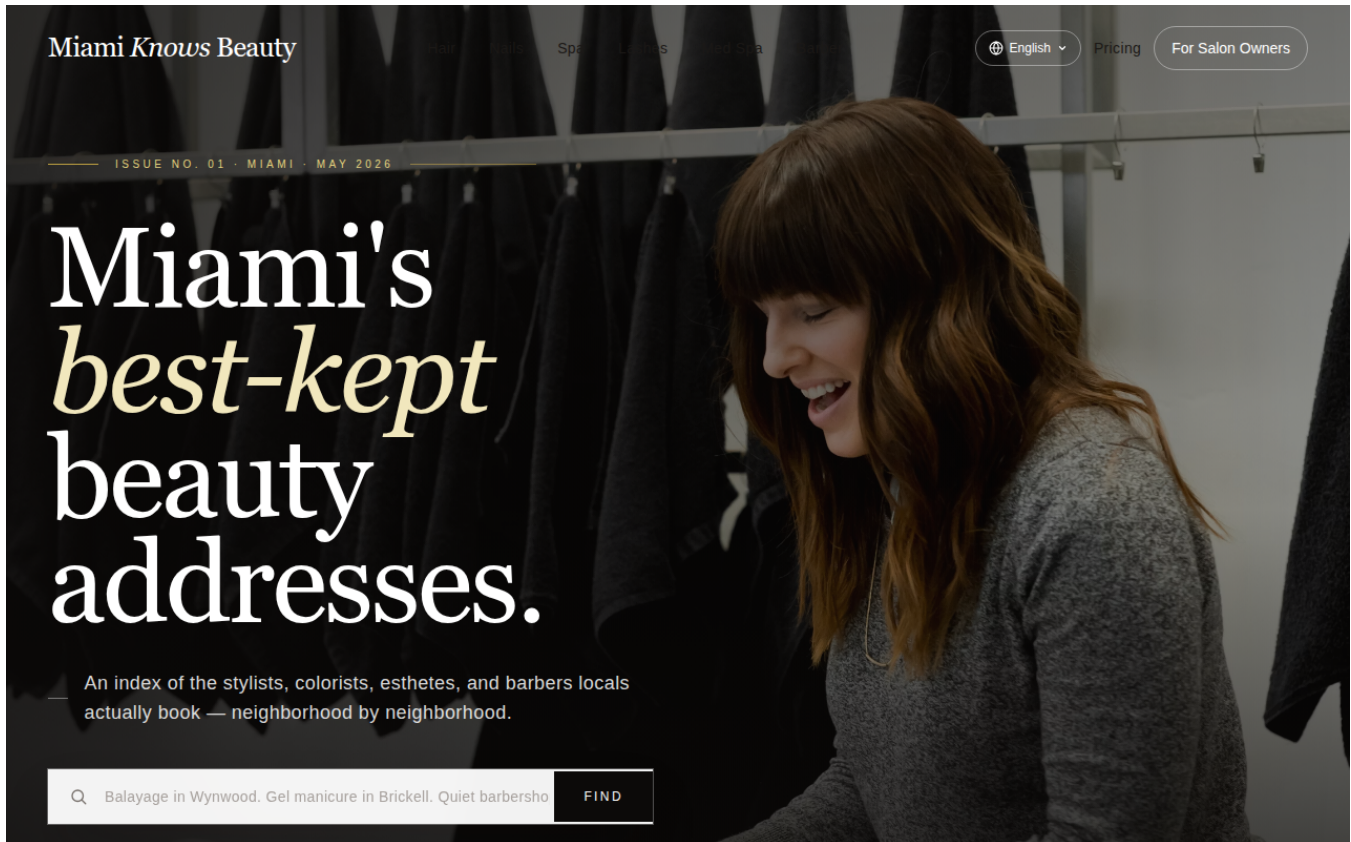
What this covers:

- ✓ The public directory — what visitors and prospective owners see
- ✓ The owner value proposition page
- ✓ The magic-link sign-in flow
- ✓ The authenticated owner dashboard and upgrade call-to-action
- ✓ The Stripe checkout experience
- ✓ Gaps, risks, and recommendations before launch

*Note on test mode: Stripe is running in **live mode** (`rk_live_...` key). The walkthrough captured the real Stripe checkout form but stopped before entering card details. A Stripe test-mode key (`sk_test_...`) is needed to run a complete end-to-end payment simulation. See the Gaps section at the end of this document.*

STEP 1 OF 9

The Public Directory — First Impression



The Miami Knows Beauty homepage makes an immediate editorial statement. The dark, image-driven hero with the tagline '*Miami's best-kept beauty addresses*' positions the brand as a curated guide, not a generic directory. Navigation categories (Hair, Nails, Spa, Lashes, Med Spa, Barber) are visible in the top navigation bar alongside a prominent 'For Salon Owners' call-to-action.

This is the first thing a salon visitor or a prospective owner customer sees. The premium aesthetic should give salon owners confidence that being featured here is worth paying for.

■ The preview gate is active — this page is not yet publicly accessible. The screenshot was taken using a preview token.

STEP 2 OF 9

A Business Listing — What Salons Get By Default

Miami *Knows* Beauty

[Hair](#) [Nails](#) [Spa](#) [Lashes](#) [Med Spa](#) [Barber](#)

English ▾

Pricing

For Salon Owners

Miami · South Beach · Spa · Eliá Spa at The Ritz-Carlton, South Beach

SOUTH BEACH · SPA · \$\$\$\$

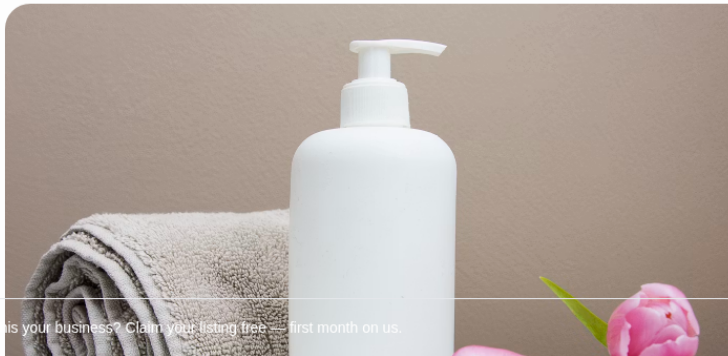
Eliá Spa at The Ritz-Carlton, South Beach

An elevated spa retreat with luxe body treatments and facials in a refined South Beach setting. Perfect for a full reset day.

EDITORIAL SELECTION

Price tier \$\$\$\$
Neighborhood South Beach
Category Spa

★ Editor's Pick ♦ Featured listing



is your business? Claim your listing free — first month on us.

Claim free →

Every Miami beauty business in our database already has a listing page at [miami.knowsbeauty.com/b/\[slug\]](https://miami.knowsbeauty.com/b/[slug]). This is the detail page for *Eliá Spa at The Ritz-Carlton, South Beach*. Pre-populated data includes the business name, neighborhood, category, and description. This is what salon owners will find when they search for their own business.

The free listing is the foundation of our value proposition: *'Your listing is already here — claim it and make it shine.'* Owners don't start from scratch; they inherit an existing listing and upgrade it.

STEP 3 OF 9

The Owner Value Proposition — 'For Salon Owners'

Miami *Knows* Beauty

[Hair](#) [Nails](#) [Spa](#) [Lashes](#) [Med Spa](#) [Barber](#)

[English](#)

[Pricing](#)

[For Salon Owners](#)

FOR BUSINESS OWNERS

Run a salon in Miami? *Your listing's already here.*

Every credible salon in Miami starts out listed in Miami Knows Beauty. Free. No claim required. Claim yours to take control of the profile, get found by people searching tonight, and unlock the tools that bring bookings to the door.

Join 50+ Miami Salons already in the directory — early claimers get **Founding Partner** status on their profile while it lasts.

WHAT'S INCLUDED WITH FEATURED

- ◆ Featured badge on every search result
- ◆ 12 photos + hero image
- ◆ AI Instagram captions & ad copy — live now
- ◆ First month free · cancel anytime

Business name *

e.g. Miami salon

Start typing and we'll match your listing automatically.

Your name *

Your email *

When an owner clicks 'For Salon Owners' in the navigation, they reach **owners** — a marketing page aimed at convincing them to claim their listing. The page leads with the hook: *'Run a salon in Miami? Your listing's already here.'*

The two-step flow is clear: claim your listing, then upgrade to Featured. This is the bridge between the public directory and the owner dashboard. A call-to-action form appears here to begin the claiming process.

STEP 4 OF 9

Owner Sign-In — Email Entry

Miami Knows Beauty

Hair

Nails

Spa

Lashes

Med Spa

Barber

English

Pricing

For Salon Owners

FOR BUSINESS OWNERS

Sign in to *your* account.

Enter the email you use for your business. We'll send you a one-time code.

Email

you@yourbusiness.com

Send me a code

New here? [Claim your listing →](#)

Clicking 'Claim your listing' or 'For Salon Owners' leads to the owner sign-in page at **/owners/login**. The login is passwordless — owners enter their business email and receive a one-time code. No account creation, no password management.

The copy is clear and warm: *'Sign in to your account. Enter the email you use for your business. We'll send you a one-time code.'* There is also a 'New here? Claim your listing →' link for first-time owners. The form is minimal — one field, one button.

■ The login is powered by Resend (email API). The Resend API key must be active in the production container for codes to be delivered. This was fixed in the June 11, 2026 session.

STEP 5 OF 9

Owner Sign-In — Code Verification

Miami *Knows* Beauty

[Hair](#) [Nails](#) [Spa](#) [Lashes](#) [Med Spa](#) [Barber](#)

 English ▾

[Pricing](#)

[For Salon Owners](#)

FOR BUSINESS OWNERS

Sign in to *your* account.

Enter the email you use for your business. We'll send you a one-time code.

We sent a 6-character code to **demo@example.com**. Check your inbox (and spam, just in case).

Code

A1B2C3

Verify

[Use a different email](#)

New here? [Claim your listing](#) →

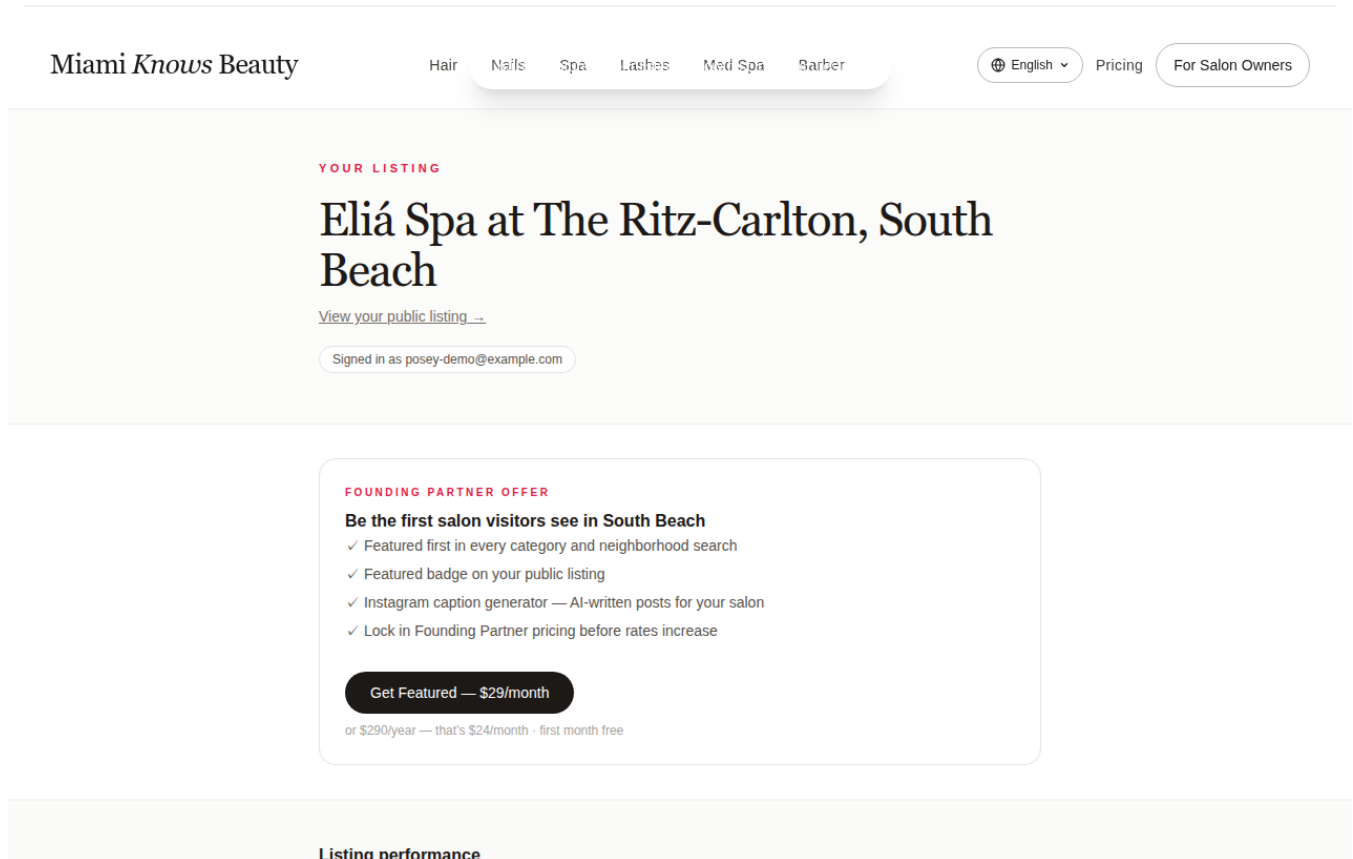
After submitting their email, the page transitions (without a full page reload) to the code entry step. The owner sees a confirmation message: *'We sent a 6-character code to [email]. Check your inbox (and spam, just in case).'*

The code input field shows a placeholder like 'A1B2C3' to illustrate the expected format. A 'Use a different email' link lets owners correct a typo without refreshing. There is no expiry countdown visible — codes last 15 minutes on the server side. Once the correct code is entered, the owner is signed in and redirected to their dashboard.

■ The AJAX-based flow (no full page reload between steps) is a nice touch — feels native and avoids the flash/blank-page that a traditional form submission would cause.

STEP 6 OF 9

The Owner Dashboard — Listing Overview & Upgrade Prompt



After signing in, the owner lands on **owners/me** — their personal dashboard. The page immediately confirms which listing they own: 'YOUR LISTING — *Eliá Spa at The Ritz-Carlton, South Beach*' with a direct link to view the public listing.

The upgrade call-to-action is the most prominent element on the page — a card labeled **FOUNDING PARTNER OFFER** with four benefit bullets:

■ ✓ *Featured first in every category and neighborhood search* ✓ *Featured badge on your public listing* ✓ *Instagram caption generator — AI-written posts for your salon* ✓ *Lock in Founding Partner pricing before rates increase* The 'Get Featured — \$29/month' button (or '\$290/year — that's \$24/month · first month free') is the single conversion point from free to paid. The urgency framing ('Founding Partner pricing') is effective.

❖ Marketing AI — See It In Action

Featured subscribers get two AI-powered marketing tools built into their dashboard — no extra apps, no copywriting skills required. Type what you want to promote and the AI writes it for you, in your salon's voice and neighborhood.

Instagram Caption Generator

The owner types a short description of what they want to promote. The AI returns a ready-to-post Instagram caption with relevant hashtags and emoji — already tuned to their salon's name, neighborhood, and category. One click to copy it.

20% off balayage this weekend — limited slots available

Generate caption

[Generate another](#)

Doral, your weekend glow-up is calling ✨ Enjoy 20% off balayage this weekend at Luxe Salon Doral, with limited slots available. Book now before spots fill up!

#Doral #LuxeSalonDoral #Balayage #HairColor #SalonSpecial #DoralBeauty #WeekendGlow
👩‍💇‍🌟💖

Copy

Real AI-generated result. Prompt: '20% off balayage this weekend — limited slots available'

Ad Copy Generator

Three ad copy variations — each with a headline and description — ready to paste directly into Google Ads, Facebook Ads, or Instagram Ads. Headlines stay under 30 characters; descriptions under 90. No reformatting required.

Summer specials — balayage, highlights, and color starting at \$120

Generate ad copy

[Generate new variations](#)

Fresh Summer Color

Balayage, highlights, and color starting at \$120 at Luxe Salon Doral.

Doral's Summer Glow

Refresh your look with expert balayage, highlights, and color from \$120.

Local Luxury, New Color

Treat yourself to summer specials at Luxe Salon Doral, starting at \$120.

 Copy all

Real AI-generated result. Prompt: 'Summer specials — balayage, highlights, and color starting at \$120'

STEP 7 OF 9

What Owners Can Edit — Profile, Hours, Photos

Miami Knows Beauty

[Hair](#) [Nails](#) [Spa](#) [Lashes](#) [Med Spa](#) [Barber](#)

🌐 English ▼

Pricing

For Salon Owners

Fri

☐ Closed

--:-- --

🕒

-

--:-- --

🕒

Sat

☐ Closed

--:-- --

🕒

-

--:-- --

🕒

Sun

☐ Closed

--:-- --

🕒

-

--:-- --

🕒

SERVICES

[+ Add service](#)

Save changes

Signed in as [posey-demo@example.com](#).

[Sign out](#)

Photos

1 of 12 photos

Photos appear in the gallery on your public listing. The first photo is used as the main listing image. JPEG, PNG, or WebP · up to 10 MB each · maximum 12 photos.



Scrolling down on the owner dashboard reveals the listing editor. Owners can manage their business hours (per-day open/close times with 'Closed' toggles), services, and photos directly from this page. A 'Save changes' button commits edits immediately.

The photos section (visible at the bottom of this screenshot) shows '1 of 12 photos' with a clear upload instruction. This editing capability is available on the free plan — upgrading to Featured does not gate basic profile management.

■ *This editing capability is available before payment — giving owners a reason to stay engaged even if they do not upgrade immediately.*

STEP 8 OF 9

The Payment — Stripe Checkout for Pro Subscription

← Expertly AI

Subscribe to Miami Knows Beauty Pro Listing

\$29.00 per month

Miami Knows Beauty Pro Listing \$29.00
Pro salon listing on Miami Knows Beauty — featured placement, photo gallery, owner dashboard, AI tools
Billed monthly

Subtotal \$29.00

Add promotion code

Total due today \$29.00

Pay with link

OR

Contact information

Email posey-demo@example.com

Payment method

☒ Card

☐ US bank account

☒ Save my information for faster checkout
Pay securely at Expertly, LLC and everywhere is accepted.

Phone number

(201) 555-0123

Subscribe

By subscribing, you authorize Expertly, LLC to charge you according to the terms until you cancel.

You also agree to the [Link Terms](#) and [Privacy Policy](#).

Powered by [stripe](#) | [Terms](#) [Privacy](#)

Real Stripe-hosted checkout page, live mode, \$29/month — payment not completed during this test.

Clicking 'Get Featured — \$29/month' on the dashboard calls the backend API (**POST /api/v1/billing/checkout**) which creates a Stripe Checkout Session and redirects the owner to a hosted Stripe payment page.

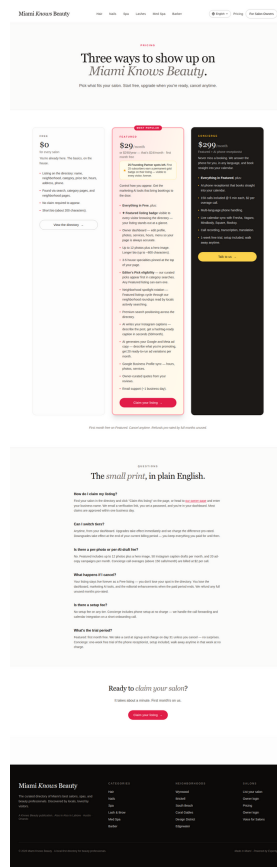
The Stripe page is clean and on-brand. Key elements visible:

■ • Product name: 'Subscribe to Miami Knows Beauty Pro Listing' • Price: \$29.00 per month, billed monthly • Description: 'Pro salon listing on Miami Knows Beauty — featured placement, photo gallery, owner dashboard, AI tools' • Email pre-filled from the owner session — no double entry • 'Add promotion code' field for future discount codes • Payment options: Card (Visa/MC/Amex/Discover) and US bank account • 'Pay with Link' fast-checkout option • 'Subscribe' CTA button ■

IMPORTANT: This screenshot shows the LIVE Stripe checkout (`rk_live_...` key). No card was entered — the walkthrough stopped here. To test a complete end-to-end payment, a Stripe test key (`sk_test_...`) is needed so we can use card 4242 4242 4242. This is the most critical gap before going live.

STEP 9 OF 9

After Payment — What the Owner Sees



After a successful Stripe payment, Stripe redirects the owner to **/owners/me?subscribed=1**. As of this walkthrough, the dashboard does not yet show a distinct 'you are now subscribed!' confirmation state — the owner sees the same dashboard. This is a known gap (see Gaps section below).

The pricing page (shown here as a reference) outlines the three tiers for owners and visitors alike: Free listing (\$0), Featured/Pro (\$29/month), and Concierge (\$299/month). This page provides context for what a newly-subscribed owner has purchased.

■ Stripe sends a payment confirmation email automatically. But the dashboard should also show a clear 'Featured Active' or 'Subscription Active' state after payment. This is needed before launch.

Gaps & Recommendations Before Launch

■ CRITICAL — No end-to-end payment test possible (Stripe test mode missing)

The production Stripe configuration uses the live restricted key (`rk_live_...`). Stripe test cards (4242 4242 4242 4242) only work in test mode. We cannot simulate a complete payment without a test key. Before going live, we need to: (1) create a test-mode Stripe restricted key in the Stripe dashboard, (2) add it to the server as `STRIPE_SECRET_KEY_TEST`, (3) run a full end-to-end payment test in test mode.

■ CRITICAL — No post-payment confirmation UI

The owner dashboard does not visually change after a successful Stripe payment. The success URL is `/owners/me?subscribed=1` but the page currently ignores the `subscribed` parameter. Owners should see a clear confirmation — 'You're now a Founding Partner!' — and the upgrade CTA should disappear and be replaced with a 'Featured Active' badge.

■ IMPORTANT — No subscription management page

There is no `/owners/subscription` or equivalent page for managing an existing subscription. Visiting `/owners/subscription` returns a 404. Once subscribed, how does an owner cancel, update their card, or see their billing history? A 'Manage Subscription' link to the Stripe customer portal (Stripe's hosted billing portal) would solve this without custom code.

■ IMPORTANT — No post-subscription dashboard state for claimed owner

After subscribing, the 'Founding Partner Offer' upgrade card should be replaced with a subscription status indicator. Something like 'Featured Plan Active — Founding Partner Rate locked in.' Without this, a subscribed owner might be confused about whether the payment went through.

■ WORKING WELL — Magic link login

The passwordless email login works end-to-end: email entry → code delivery via Resend → code verification → authenticated session. The AJAX flow (no page reload between steps) is smooth. The session cookie is HMAC-signed and valid for 30 days.

■ WORKING WELL — Stripe checkout API

The checkout endpoint (POST `/api/v1/billing/checkout`) correctly validates the owner session, looks up the claimed business, creates a Stripe Checkout Session, and returns the redirect URL. Email is pre-filled in the Stripe form from the owner session — good UX.

■ WORKING WELL — Owner dashboard upgrade CTA

The 'Founding Partner Offer' card on the dashboard is visually prominent and well-written. The pricing options (\$29/month and \$290/year with the per-month equivalent shown) are clear. The 'first month free' incentive is compelling.

This document was prepared on June 12, 2026 by Posey (Product Manager, Miami Knows Beauty). Screenshots are from the live production site at miami.knowsbeauty.com in preview mode. Test data was cleaned up after this walkthrough.